



First Impressions: PS4

Sony just launched the PS4 in India. Take a first look at the next-gen gaming console.
<http://dgit.in/ps41st>

Nokia Wearables?

Nokia's Android smartphone may have to wait. Rumours say they have decided to focus on wearables.
<http://dgit.in/nokrumors>

Space Age

The dark side(s) of the Moon

Mankind's oldest mystery – Is the moon really brighter on the other side.

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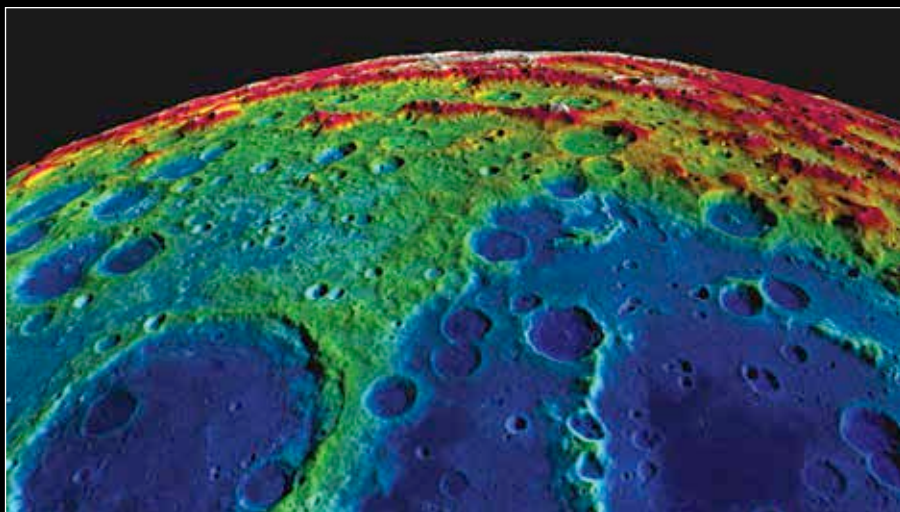
Humanity's love affair with the Moon is legend. From its ascension as a mythological deity across all cultures to being the focus of scientific human achievement during the 20th century. Along with being the only celestial body other than Earth that humans have walked on.

We have traveled to the Moon, landed envoys on Mars, our probes have voyaged through the Kuiper belt and far into the distant reaches of the galaxy but our obsession with the Moon hasn't diminished. Like any real first love, humanity ponders and muses about it even decades after its last touch.

And even as science and technology, art and culture, myth and superstitions have attempted to explain its many subtle traits and moods, the Moon has remained a shrewish mistress, having withheld its deepest secrets for as long as it has populated our imagination. Leaving us in doubt even as to its origins. So once more unto the breach dear friends and let us try to demystify our first true love.

The Far Side of the Moon

Over its 4.5 billion years of history the Moon has evolved from a proto-normal entity to the awesome vision we see today.



DLR Institute of Planetary Research took 3D images of the Moon's far side showing a scarred surface with an extreme range of elevations.

Constantly keeping people fascinated with the notion of its "dark side". Deeply rooted in the memory of modern society as the iconic Pink Floyd album, the misconceptions regarding the dark side of the Moon have led to numerous false theories, ranging from secret alien bases to well, more exotic extra-terrestrial conspiracies.

But to clarify - there are no aliens on the Moon. That we're aware of. Or that we're allowed to tell you. Moving on.

The fact that we can only see one side of the Moon - the "near side" - is the result of inter-stellar forces and orbit alignments. The science is very simple - the Moon completes one orbit around the Earth in approximately 29 days which is exactly how long it takes to complete one rotation on it's own axis. This coincidental synchronicity results in a "tidal lock" so only one side of the Moon is facing the Earth at all times.

The common misconception that the "dark side" of the Moon or more accurately - the "far side" - doesn't receive sunlight

is false. Due to the nature of the Moon's rotation in relation to its visibility from the Earth, it appears as if the "near side" of the Moon is the only surface reflecting sunlight but in actuality the "far side" also witnesses a sunrise and sunset.

Unveiling of the Face

Since the dawn of humanity the misconceptions and myths surrounding the moon have naturally risen to fill the void of ignorance that could not be filled given the limitations of the times. And it was only in 1959 did we capture a glimpse of the far side of the Moon.

In October 1959, a Soviet probe - Luna 3 - photographed, developed and transmitted images of the far side of the Moon to Earth. The grainy images recovered from that mission were soon replaced with first hand eyewitness accounts as within a decade of the Soviet's victory, the members of the Apollo 8 mission - Borman, Lovell, and Anders - received an early Christmas gift, as they became the first humans to see